

CORAL REEFS

The Importance of Protecting Our Ocean Reefs

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CS-150



WHAT ARE CORAL REEFS?

- A coral reef is a term used to describe the collective structure of hard corals that help shape a coral reef ecosystem
- Coral are actually animal



WHY DO THEY MATTER?

- Nearly a quarter of all the fish in the sea rely on healthy coral reefs
- Millions of people around the world rely on fish caught in and around coral reefs
- Protect people and land from storms



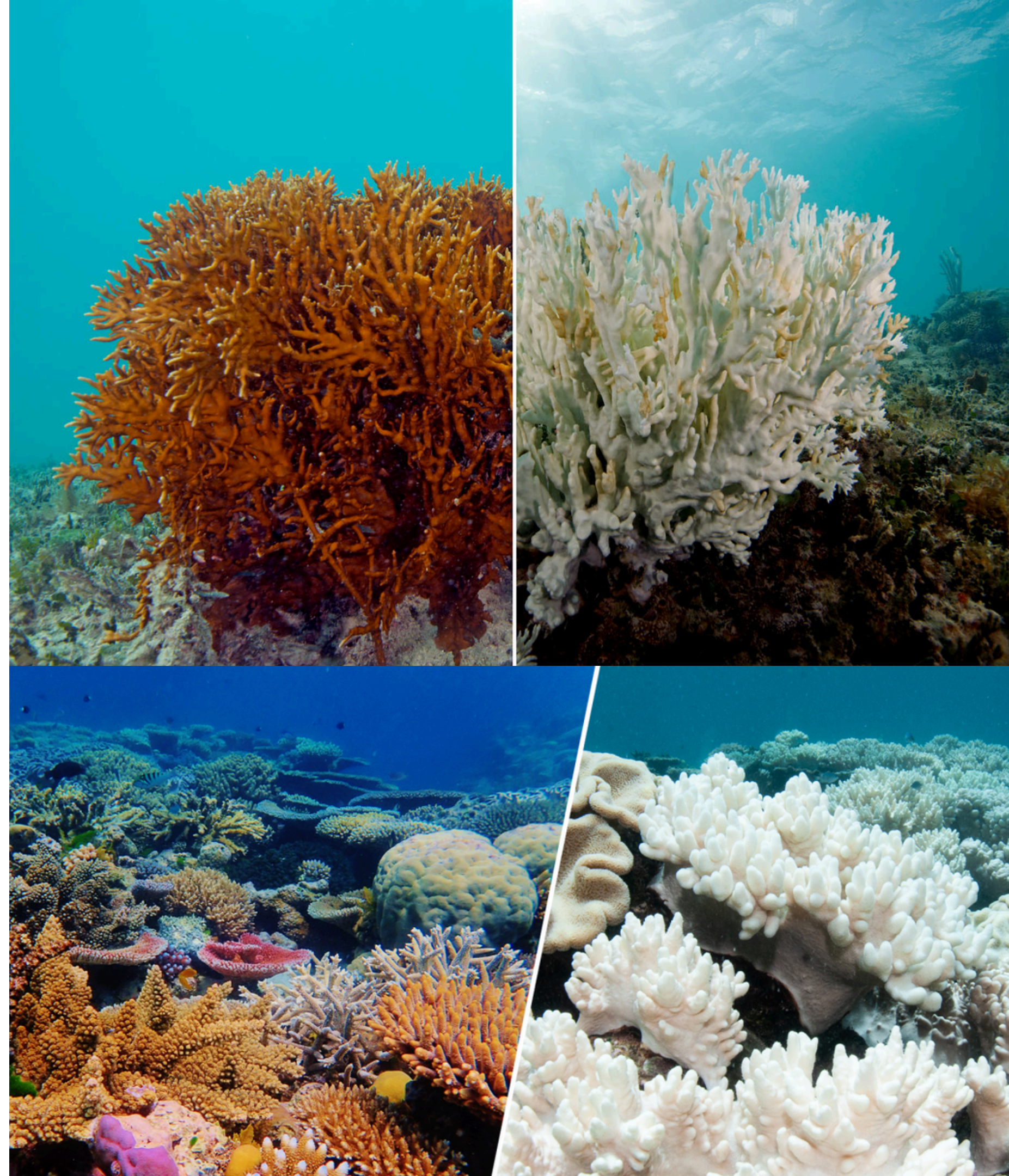


CURRENT STATE OF THE REEFS

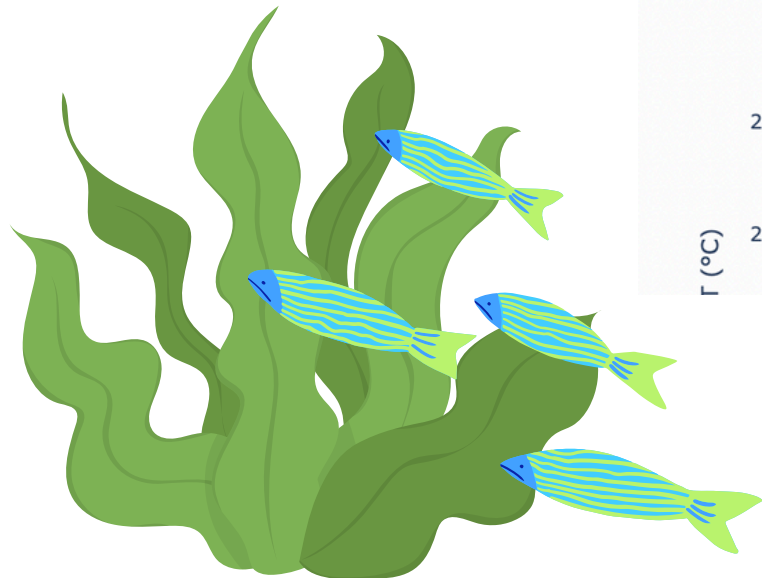
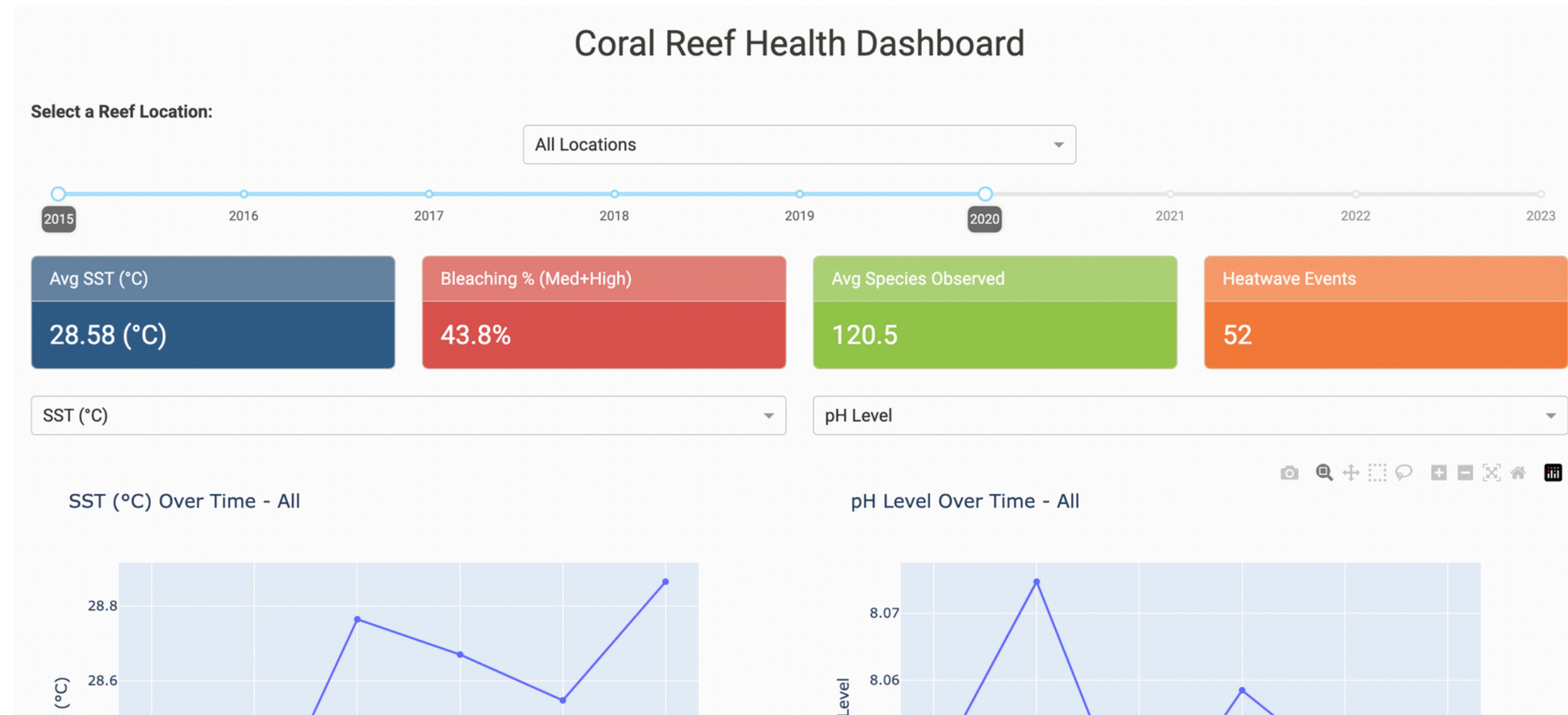
- The world has lost nearly 20 percent of its coral reefs
- Pollution and increasing ocean temperatures are two major causes of coral bleaching

CORAL BLEACHING

- As water temperatures rise, it causes corals to expel their zooxanthellae
- Once coral dies it is rare it comes back



LETS LOOK AT THE DASH



WHAT CAN WE DO?

- Reduce use of fertilizers
- Reduce energy use
- Invest in reef safe products
- Spread the word



